

Porn company wants Napster

Private Media Group, a pronography firm, offered to acquire the Napster trademark and the Napster.com Internet address for 1 million shares of Private Media stock. The company said that it planned to create a peer-to-peer network that would promote the sharing of pornography. It would also sell pornographic material on the site. "Along with Hollywood and the recording industry, we have become increasingly concerned about the level of copyright infringement inherent in free peer-to-peer file swapping services," said Charles Prast, president and



chief executive officer of Private Media. "We intend to use the strength of the Napster trademark to build a community for adults to share our content." The announcement came less than two weeks after a bankruptcy court judge blocked Napster's sale to German media giant Bertelsmann AG who offered over \$15 million, plus \$85 million in loans to keep the file-swapping service in operation while it was being pursued through the courts for copyright infringement.

snapshot

Steve Jobs is the highest-paid executive, collecting **\$43.5 million** in 2002

Source: Economic Research Institute

Kill spammers... literally!

An online game offering virtual revenge on spammers is gaining cult status as Netizens queue up to take out their frustrations at receiving spam.



If only this wasn't a game!

Torture a Spammer was devised by a US company, Marketing-Sherpa, after the theft and misuse of more than 10 million of

its customers' e-mail addresses.

Apparently, an ex-employee of SparkList.com, its mailing list host, sold a backup copy of the list to spammers.

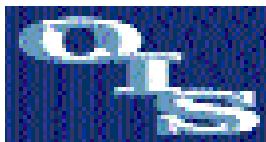
Various icons represent different kinds of spammers such as a blond in a red bikini for pornography, a purple and white pill for the Viagra e-mails and a man in a trench coat as an online salesman. Players can choose their method of attack from gruesome punishments such as boiling oil and flying killer monkeys. You can play Torture a Spammer at <http://torturegame.email-sherpa.com/>.

Vulnerability reporting guidelines

Eleven software makers and security firms have announced the formation of a group called the Organization for Internet Safety (OIS, www.oisafety.org), which intends to set down rules regarding how the security community should responsibly release information on software flaws. The members of the group include security companies @Stake, Bind-View, Foundation, Guardent, ISS, NAI, and Symantec as well as software makers Caldera International, Microsoft, Oracle and SGI. They hope to bridge the gap between security firms and independent consultants who release information about flaws to grab media attention and the software companies that frequently find themselves with egg on their face over the holes in their applications. "Today,

there are no agreed-upon processes for handling security vulnerabilities," the group said. "The lack of any consensus procedures complicates the process of fixing vulnerabilities, and ultimately increases the risk that all computer users face."

OIS will only provide guidelines and no enforcement mechanism will be advocated. Earlier this year, a draft of such guidelines was submitted to the Internet Engineering Task Force (IETF), only to be turned down as being outside IETF's purview. The proposed rules suggest that companies respond to security researchers within a week of being notified of a potential flaw and that researchers give software companies at least 30 days to fix the flaw before making information about it public.



heroes

Cyberlaws

A 28-year-old computer engineer from UK was sentenced to 18 months for hacking into a firm's database. A Russian hacker was sentenced to three years in prison for a computer crime. A 21-year-old man has been arrested and his equipment seized for the creation of the Linux T0rn virus.

P2P Services

The operator of the KaZaA music-swapping service announced a partnership with one of Europe's major Internet access providers in a deal that underscores their mutual benefit from a method of exchanging songs that has raised the ire of record companies worldwide.

zeroes

Advertising invading games

Electronic Arts has struck product placement deals with McDonalds and Intel for *Sims Online*. Chipzilla and Burgerzilla will feature in the game, while players will be able to open a virtual McDonalds franchise and eating there will give them more points. Intel introduces Pentium branding and the Intel Inside jingle.

Storage technology

DataPlay, a start-up that developed a new secure media format to replace the CD, has shut down, at least temporarily for new funding. Major record labels had supported the format and DataPlay expected to have discs on the market by the end of October 2002.

■ Dell offers free processor upgrades on Latitude notebooks ■ Nokia unveils 3G phone that captures video clips ■ Sun to ship Solaris 9 for x86 at \$99